

Table 8.5 Size Statistics

Description	Up Breakout	Down Breakout
Tall pattern performance	48%	−17%
Short pattern performance	42%	−12%
Median height as a percentage of breakout price	12.0%	13.2%
Narrow pattern performance	46%	−14%
Wide pattern performance	44%	−16%
Median width	41 days	39 days
Short and narrow performance	39%	−13%
Short and wide performance	49%	−11%
Tall and wide performance	42%	−17%
Tall and narrow performance	63%	−17%

Warning: Just because a pattern is tall does not mean it'll outperform. The numbers are an average of hundreds of perfect trades. Plus, you might flub the trade anyway.

Width. Width is not as strong an indicator for future performance as is height. The table shows an example of this, too. After an upward breakout, narrow patterns outperform but wide ones do better after downward breakouts.

To determine width, measure the calendar days from the start of the pattern to the end and compare the result to the median width in the table. A value higher than the median means it's wide.

Height and width combinations. According to the table for upward breakouts, if tall patterns outperform and narrow patterns outperform, you'd expect the combination of tall and narrow to be the best performer. Indeed, that's what happens, but that's not always the case.

For downward breakouts, tall and wide patterns should outperform, but the results show that anything tall is best. Avoid short patterns.